

mortgage and car payments. You can stop paid work or choose to work because you enjoy it. When money is no longer the driving force behind your decisions, your motivations change.

Choosing FI is all about giving you the power to choose what you want. Many people envision retirement as a time of rest, relaxation, and recreation. There are certainly benefits to slowing down, focusing on relationships, and living a less stressful life. But if everyone who chooses FI opts for a life of leisure, our mission will have been a failure. FI is far bigger than retirement.

Once we are freed from the standard path and have the means to support ourselves indefinitely, we can shift our focus from day to day survival to thinking about bigger things. Carl of *1500 Days to Freedom* said, “I think we owe it to the world to give back in some way, either our time or money, at some point in life.” Tanja Hester of *Our Next Life* shared a similar sentiment when asked what will determine if her efforts to achieve FI will have been worth it. She answered, “If we can ultimately leave the world a better place than we found it, if we can make a positive impact on people.”

Spreading the Superpower